

Word family: **catch / caught / catching / catchy**

Base word: catch

Past tense: caught

Past participle: caught

Related forms: catching, catchy, catch

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective (相關形式)

Your sentence:

> “The ad immediately **caught** my attention.”

Meaning in this passage

Meaning: To attract someone’s attention so that they notice or become interested in something.

繁體中文: **吸引某人的注意, 使對方立即留意到某事物**

中文翻譯:

「那則廣告立即**吸引了我的注意**。」

catch someone’s attention = 吸引某人的注意, 使其留意某事物

1. **catch + attention/interest/eye (注意力／興趣／目光) — 吸引注意; 引起興趣**

Meaning: To make someone notice or become interested in something.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The ad immediately **caught** my attention.”

「那則廣告立即**吸引了我的注意**。」

Practice 2

> “The bright red packaging **caught** my eye.”

「鮮紅色的包裝立即**吸引了我的目光**。」

Practice 3

> “One sentence in the report **caught** my interest.”

「報告中的一句話**引起了我的興趣**。」

****catch attention/interest/eye = 吸引某人的注意、目光或興趣****

2. ****catch + moving/falling object (移動／掉落中的物件) — 接住; 抓住****

****Meaning:**** To stop and hold something that is moving or falling, usually with your hands.

Practice 4

> “She threw me the keys, and I ****caught**** them.”

「她把鎖匙拋給我，我把它們****接住了****。」

Practice 5

> “He managed to ****catch**** the glass before it hit the floor.”

「杯子掉到地上之前，他及時把它****接住了****。」

****catch = 把正在移動或掉落的物件接住****

3. ****catch + person/animal (正在逃跑或難以捉到的人／動物) — 捉住; 捕獲****

****Meaning:**** To capture a person or animal that is moving away, escaping, or difficult to capture.

Practice 6

> “The police ****caught**** the thief later that evening.”

「警方當晚較遲時****捉到了****那名小偷。」

Practice 7

> “The cat finally ****caught**** the mouse.”

「那隻貓終於****捉到了****老鼠。」

****catch = 成功捉住正在逃走或難以捕捉的人／動物****

4. **catch + fish/animal**(以捕魚／狩獵方式取得的動物) — 捕捉; 捕獲

Meaning: To obtain fish or animals by fishing, trapping, etc.

This is closely related to #3, but it is useful to distinguish because it commonly refers to **fishing/hunting as an activity**, not chasing an escaping individual.

Practice 8

> “We **caught** three fish that morning.”

「我們那天早上**捕到了**三條魚。」

Practice 9

> “The fishermen hope to **catch** more fish tomorrow.”

「漁民希望明天可以**捕到**更多魚。」

catch = 透過捕魚／捕獵取得動物

5. **catch + transport**(巴士／火車／飛機等) — 趕上並乘搭

Meaning: To arrive in time to travel on a particular bus, train, plane, etc.

Practice 10

> “I need to **catch** the 7:30 train.”

「我需要**趕上並乘搭** 7:30 的火車。」

Practice 11

> “If we leave now, we can still **catch** the last bus.”

「如果我們現在出發，仍然可以**趕上尾班巴士**。」

catch + transport = 及時趕上並乘搭某班交通工具

6. **catch + illness/infection (疾病／感染) — 染上；感染**

Meaning: To become infected with an illness.

Practice 12

> “I think I’ve **caught** a cold.”

「我想我**感冒了／染上傷風了**。」

Practice 13

> “He **caught** the flu from a colleague.”

「他從同事那裡**感染了流感**。」

catch an illness = 因受到傳染而患上某種疾病

7. **catch + person + doing something (某人正在做某事) — 當場發現；撞見**

Meaning: To discover someone while they are doing something, especially something wrong, secret, or unexpected.

Practice 14

> “The teacher **caught** him cheating.”

「老師**當場發現**他作弊。」

Practice 15

> “I **caught** my brother eating my chocolate.”

「我**撞見**弟弟正在吃我的朱古力。」

catch someone doing something = 當場發現／撞見某人正在做某事

8. **catch + brief sight/sound/words/detail (短暫看到／聽到的資訊) — 捕捉到；聽到；看到**

****Meaning:**** To manage to see, hear, or notice something briefly or incompletely.

This covers expressions such as:

* ****catch a glimpse**** = 瞥見

* ****catch a word/name**** = 聽到某個字／名字

* ****catch a sound**** = 聽到聲音

Practice 16

> “I ****caught**** a glimpse of him as he entered the lift.”

「他走進升降機時，我****短暫瞥見了他****。」

Practice 17

> “I didn’t ****catch**** your name.”

「我剛才****沒有聽清楚你的名字****。」

****catch** = 在很短時間內成功看到、聽到或注意到某些資訊

9. ****catch + meaning/joke/reference**(意思／笑話／暗示) — 聽懂; 領會

****Meaning:**** To understand something that was said, especially something subtle, quick, or indirect.

Practice 18

> “Sorry, I didn’t ****catch**** the joke.”

「不好意思，我剛才****沒有聽懂那個笑話****。」

Practice 19

> “Did you ****catch**** what she meant?”

「你有沒有****領會她的意思****？」

****catch** = 理解說話中的意思、笑點或暗示

This differs from #8:

* **I didn't catch your name.** → 沒聽清楚

* **I didn't catch the joke.** → 聽到了, 但沒理解

10. **catch + fire (物件開始燃燒) — 著火; 起火**

Meaning: To begin burning.

Practice 20

> “The curtain **caught** fire.”

「窗簾**著火**了。」

Practice 21

> “Dry grass can easily **catch** fire.”

「乾草很容易**起火**。」

catch fire = 開始燃燒／著火

11. **catch + light/sunlight (光線) — 受到光線照射而反光／顯眼**

Meaning: For light to strike something so that it becomes bright, reflective, or noticeable.

Practice 22

> “Her ring **caught** the light.”

「她的戒指**受到光線照射後閃閃發亮**。」

Practice 23

> “The glass building **caught** the afternoon sunlight.”

「那座玻璃大樓**映照著午後陽光**。」

catch the light = 光線照在物件上, 使其反光或變得顯眼

12. **catch + body part/clothing/object(身體／衣物／物件) on/in something — 被勾住; 卡住**

****Meaning:**** To become accidentally trapped, hooked, or stuck on something.

This is ****not a phrasal verb****; it is the ordinary verb ****catch**** describing physical snagging.

Practice 24

> “Her sleeve ****caught**** on the door handle.”

「她的衣袖****被門柄勾住了****。」

Practice 25

> “My bag ****caught**** on the edge of the chair.”

「我的袋子****卡在椅子的邊緣****。」

****catch = 物件意外被某處勾住或卡住****

13. ****catch + person before they fall(阻止某人跌倒) — 扶住; 接住****

****Meaning:**** To grab or support someone in time to prevent them from falling.

Practice 26

> “She slipped, but I ****caught**** her.”

「她滑了一下, 但我及時****扶住了她****。」

Practice 27

> “He ****caught**** the child before she fell down the stairs.”

「小孩跌下樓梯前, 他及時把她****接住／扶住了****。」

****catch someone = 在某人跌倒前及時扶住或接住****

This is an extension of #2, but it is worth showing as a common human-object pattern rather than treating it as a completely new lexical sense.

14. **catch = become trapped by a mechanism/obstacle (機件／物件卡住) — 卡住; 咬住**

Meaning: For something to become stuck or fail to move freely because part of it is trapped.

Practice 28

> “The door keeps **catching** on the floor.”

「那扇門一直**卡著地板, 不能順暢開關**。」

Practice 29

> “The zipper **caught** halfway up.”

「拉鏈拉到一半時**卡住了**。」

catch = 因某部分被阻礙而卡住、無法順暢移動

15. **catch = manage to see/hear a programme/event (趕上觀看／收聽某節目或活動) — 看到; 趕上觀看**

Meaning: To manage to see or hear a programme, performance, event, etc., often because you are available at the right time.

Practice 30

> “Did you **catch** the news last night?”

「你昨晚有沒有**看到那節新聞**？」

Practice 31

> “I’d like to **catch** the exhibition before it closes.”

「展覽結束前, 我想**抽時間去看看**。」

catch a programme/event = 成功趕上並觀看／收聽某節目或活動

This is related to both “see” and “arrive in time,” but the established use is common enough to teach separately.

16. **catch = amount of fish/animals caught (一次捕獲的魚／獵物) — 捕獲量; 漁獲**

Here, **catch** is a noun.

Meaning: The fish or animals caught during one period of fishing or hunting.

Practice 32

> “The fishermen returned with a large **catch**.”

「漁民帶著大量**漁獲**回來。」

Practice 33

> “Today’s **catch** was smaller than yesterday’s.”

「今天的**捕獲量／漁獲**比昨天少。」

catch = 一次捕魚／捕獵所得到的漁獲或獵物

17. **catch = successful act of catching something (成功接住物件的一次動作) — 接球; 接住**

Here, **catch** is a noun.

Meaning: An instance of successfully catching something thrown or hit.

Practice 34

> “That was an excellent **catch**.”

「那次**接球**非常漂亮。」

Practice 35

> “He made a difficult **catch** near the boundary.”

「他在邊界附近完成了一次很困難的**接球**。」

catch = 成功接住球或其他移動物件的一次動作

18. **catch = hidden disadvantage/condition (表面看來很好但暗藏的不利條件) — 陷阱; 隱藏條件**

A very important conversational noun sense.

Meaning: A hidden problem, disadvantage, or condition in an apparently attractive offer or situation.

Practice 36

> “The apartment is very cheap. What's the **catch**?”

「這個單位很便宜。**是不是有甚麼隱藏問題／附帶條件？**」

Practice 37

> “There's a **catch**: you have to sign a three-year contract.”

「有一個**不太理想的附帶條件**: 你必須簽三年合約。」

the catch = 表面看來有利的事情背後隱藏的不利條件或問題

19. **catch = desirable person, especially as a partner (條件很好、值得交往的對象) — 理想對象**

Here, **catch** is an informal noun.

Meaning: A person considered especially desirable as a romantic partner because of their qualities, success, appearance, etc.

Practice 38

> “Everyone thinks he's a great **catch**.”

「大家都覺得他是一個**條件很好、很理想的交往對象**。」

Practice 39

> “She is intelligent, kind, and successful — quite a **catch**.”

「她聰明、善良又成功，確實是一位**條件很好的理想伴侶**。」

a good/great catch = 條件很好、被視為理想伴侶的人

20. **catch** = fastening device (用來固定門／蓋子等的小型扣件) — 扣; 鎖扣

Here, **catch** is a noun.

Meaning: A small device that holds a door, lid, box, etc. closed.

Practice 40

> “The **catch** on the box is broken.”

「盒子的**鎖扣**壞了。」

Practice 41

> “Press the **catch** to open the lid.”

「按下**扣掣**便可以打開蓋子。」

catch = 用來把門、蓋子或盒子固定關上的小型扣件

21. **catch** = sudden pause/change in voice or breath (聲音／呼吸突然停頓) — 哽咽; 呼吸一窒

Here, **catch** is usually a noun.

Meaning: A sudden interruption or tightening in someone's voice or breathing, often because of emotion.

Practice 42

> “There was a slight **catch** in her voice.”

「她的聲音有一點**哽咽／突然停頓**。」

Practice 43

> “He spoke with a **catch** in his breath.”

「他說話時**呼吸有點突然一窒**。」

a catch in someone's voice/breath = 因情緒等令聲音或呼吸突然收緊、停頓

Related form: **catchy**

22. **catchy** = song/slogan/name (歌曲／口號／名稱) easy to remember — 容易記住、令人很快記入腦中的

Meaning: Pleasant, striking, or memorable enough to stay in your mind easily.

Practice 44

> “The advertisement used a very **catchy** song.”

「那則廣告使用了一首**很容易記住、令人很快記入腦中的歌曲。**」

Practice 45

> “They need a **catchy** slogan for the campaign.”

「他們需要一個**簡短醒目、容易令人記住的宣傳口號。**」

catchy = 容易吸引注意並令人記住的

This is especially relevant to your advertising passage.

Related form: **catching**

23. **catching** = illness/feeling/behaviour (疾病／情緒／行為) easily spreading to others — 容易傳染／感染他人的

As an adjective, **catching** can mean contagious or easily spreading.

For diseases, this use is somewhat less common today than **contagious**, but it is still understood. For emotions such as laughter, it remains useful.

Practice 46

> “Her laughter was **catching**.”

「她的笑聲**很有感染力，令其他人也忍不住笑。**」

Practice 47

> “The illness is highly **catching**.”

「這種疾病**很容易在人與人之間傳染**。」

****catching = 容易由一人傳給另一人, 或令他人產生相同反應的****

Important distinctions

**catch attention**

> “The ad caught my attention.”

= ****廣告吸引了我的注意****

**catch an object**

> “Catch the ball.”

= ****接住球****

**catch a person**

> “The police caught him.”

= ****警方捉到他****

**catch a train**

> “I caught the train.”

= ****我趕上並乘搭了火車****

**catch a cold**

> “I caught a cold.”

= ****我感染了傷風****

**catch someone doing something**

> “I caught him cheating.”

= ****我當場發現他作弊****

catch a word

> “I didn’t catch your name.”

= **我沒有聽清楚你的名字**

catch the meaning

> “I didn’t catch the joke.”

= **我沒有理解那個笑點**

a catch

> “What’s the catch?”

= **背後有甚麼隱藏的不利條件？**

catchy

> “a catchy advertisement”

= **容易吸引注意並令人記住的廣告**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
catch attention/interest/eye	吸引某人的注意、目光或興趣
catch a moving/falling object	把正在移動或掉落的物件接住
catch a person/animal	成功捉住正在逃走或難以捕捉的人／動物
catch fish/game	透過捕魚／捕獵取得動物
catch transport	及時趕上並乘搭某班交通工具
catch an illness	因受到傳染而患上疾病
catch someone doing something	當場發現某人正在做某事
catch a sight/sound/word	短暫成功看到／聽到某些資訊
catch a meaning/joke	理解說話中的意思、笑點或暗示
catch fire	開始燃燒／著火
catch the light	光線照在物件上，使其反光或顯眼
catch on/in something *(ordinary physical sense)*	被某物勾住或卡住
mechanism catches	因受阻而卡住、不能順暢移動

catch a programme/event	成功趕上並觀看／收聽某活動	
a catch — fishing	一次捕魚所得到的漁獲	
a catch — sports	成功接住球的一次動作	
the catch — disadvantage	表面有利的事情背後隱藏的不利條件	
a good catch — person	條件很好、被視為理想伴侶的人	
a catch — fastener	用來固定門、蓋子等的小型扣件	
a catch in voice/breath	聲音或呼吸因情緒等突然收緊、停頓	
catchy	容易吸引注意並令人記住的	
catching	容易傳染或令其他人產生相同反應的	

For your original sentence

> “The ad immediately **caught my attention**.”

The exact meaning is:

catch someone’s attention = 吸引某人的注意, 使對方立即留意到某事物